Gradient Pulse

2026-11-12

Resignation

• Nvidia's 8-K: on November 11, 2026, the board accepted Jen-Hsun Huang's resignation as President, CEO and board member, effective immediately; the filing and press release (both dated November 12) give no reason. — SEC Form 8-K / Nvidia press release

https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1045810/000104581026000082/nvda-20261111.htm

• Colette Kress, 59, EVP and CFO since 2013, serves as interim CEO while continuing as CFO; Harvey C. Jones, 73, a director since 1993 and former Synopsys CEO, was appointed the board's first-ever Chair; the board will consider internal and external candidates for a permanent CEO, with no timeline. — Nvidia press release (Ex. 99.1)

https://nvidianews.nvidia.com/news/nvidia-announces-ceo-transition

• Framing conflict: company documents say 'resigned'; Bloomberg and WSJ headlines say 'ousted'; Reuters reported the board met Wednesday to consider his ouster, citing a person familiar with the matter. — Reuters

https://www.reuters.com/business/retail-consumer/nvidia-ceo-jensen-huang-step-down-big-blow-ai-boom-2026-11-12/

How We Got Here

• Oct 29: NYT first reported a US intelligence assessment that former Megaspeed executive Alice Huang was passing information to Beijing / assessed as a Chinese intelligence asset who had developed a close relationship with Huang; Nov 6, NYT + FT reported she was assessed as recruited by China's MSS to target Huang. Assessments = allegations, not findings. — New York Times (via secondary timelines)

https://nvidianews.nvidia.com/news/statement-from-nvidia-board-of-directors

• Nov 8: Nvidia's board announced an independent investigation (independent directors + outside counsel) and said it had 'no reason to believe that either national security or NVIDIA secrets were compromised'; the same day Huang told staff he had been unfaithful, apologized, and pledged cooperation — naming no one. — Nvidia board statement

https://nvidianews.nvidia.com/news/statement-from-nvidia-board-of-directors

• Nov 11: NYT reported, citing five people who worked at Nvidia, a relationship between Huang and Kimberly Powell, VP of Healthcare and a direct report; NYT had not viewed the alleged footage; Nvidia and Powell have not confirmed, and no outlet has independently confirmed Powell by name (WSJ reported a relationship with a subordinate without naming her). It is unknown whether this is the relationship Huang acknowledged to staff. — Reuters (NYT report)

https://www.reuters.com/business/nvidia-ceo-huang-had-relationship-with-executive-who-reported-him-nyt-reports-2026-11-11/

Market Reaction

• NVDA closes: Fri Nov 6 $186.64; Tue Nov 10 $168.89; Wed Nov 11 $173.73 (+2.87%). Thu Nov 12 intraday: opened -14%, low $148.80, recovered to about -5% by mid-morning (Finnhub). — Finnhub / AP

https://techcrunch.com/2026/11/12/nvidias-jensen-huang-resigns-chipmaker-names-cfo-colette-kress-as-interim-ceo/

• TechCrunch calculated the shares were down as much as 19% since Friday at the worst point, a market-cap loss of more than $855 billion; Reuters measured ~$300 billion lost since Sunday's investigation announcement and noted the stock is ~40% below its October 6 high (more than $2 trillion erased since). — TechCrunch / Reuters

https://techcrunch.com/2026/11/12/nvidias-jensen-huang-resigns-chipmaker-names-cfo-colette-kress-as-interim-ceo/

• Peers diverged: AMD +2% and Broadcom up (rivals seen gaining if customers split orders); TSMC closed -2.3% in Taiwan; Nasdaq opened -1.5% and narrowed. A company shock, not a sector collapse. — Reuters / AP

https://techcrunch.com/2026/11/12/nvidias-jensen-huang-resigns-chipmaker-names-cfo-colette-kress-as-interim-ceo/

What Happens Next

• Nov 17: Nvidia Q3 FY2027 earnings, as previously scheduled — results ~4:20 p.m. ET, call 5:00 p.m. ET — presented by interim CEO Kress. Nov 18: the date three House chairs (Mast, Foreign Affairs; Moolenaar, Select Committee on the CCP; Crawford, Intelligence) requested a closed-door briefing from Huang, in a Nov 4 letter; a request, not a subpoena, though Mast has raised issuing one. — Nvidia release / House chairs' letter (press reports)

https://nvidianews.nvidia.com/news/nvidia-announces-ceo-transition

• Analyst repricing: Dan Ives cut his target $300 to $225 (kept Outperform); Baird's Tristan Gerra downgraded to Neutral, $500 to $200; Bernstein's Stacy Rasgon moved to Market Perform, $400 to $200; Morningstar's Brian Colello held a $310 fair value and named Ian Buck (hyperscale/HPC lead, CUDA creator) a logical successor — an analyst judgment; Nvidia has named no candidates. — Investor's Business Daily / Bloomberg

https://www.investors.com/news/technology/nvidia-stock-hammered-ceo-jensen-huang-future-in-doubt/

Hype Check

• Claim: Huang's resignation proves the spying reports, and the AI trade is broken. Verdict: UNPROVEN — no reason given in the filing or release; investigation findings not public; the board said it had no reason to believe secrets were compromised; the Powell report is unconfirmed; the intelligence claims are officials' assessments, not findings; and the stock recovered from -14% to about -5% intraday, arguing against the freefall version. Sequence is not causation. — Gradient Pulse Hype Check

https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1045810/000104581026000082/nvda-20261111.htm

Hype Check

Claim: Huang's resignation proves the spying reports — and the AI trade is broken

Verdict: unproven

Nvidia gave no reason for the resignation; the board's investigation findings are not public and the board itself said it had no reason to believe secrets were compromised; the Powell report is unconfirmed by any second outlet by name; the intelligence story rests on officials' assessments, which are allegations, not findings; and the stock recovered from -14% to about -5% intraday. The sequence (investigation announced Nov 8, resignation accepted Nov 11) is a fact; a causal connection is not established. Real tests are ahead: Nov 17 earnings and the Nov 18 briefing request.